

MARCO MAHRER

Talent Acquisition Partner³

 Zurich, Switzerland

 Swiss & American

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MILESTONES

4'500+ Interviews Held

350+ In-house Hires

25+ Projects Delivered

15+ Years of Experience

5 Organizations Grown

KEY SKILLS

Full-Cycle Recruiting

Leadership & Mentoring

Hiring Strategy

Sourcing & Outreach

AI & Agentic Workflows

Process Automation

Offer Negotiation

Project Management

EXPERTISE

Systems Design

Stakeholder Partnering

Candidate Experience

Employer Branding

ATS & CRM Architecture

Data-Driven Recruiting

Comp & Benchmarking

Diversity & Inclusion

LANGUAGES

English - Native

German - C2

PROFILE

Talent acquisition leader with 15+ years scaling tech hiring across Europe and the US — three unicorns grown, from startup build-outs to Google. Equally at home owning a hiring function end-to-end and carrying the req load hands-on: sourcing, interviewing, closing. Treats recruiting as a systems problem — builds the system that handles volume with precision, so recruiters and hiring managers spend their time on judgment. AI drafts, coordinates, and ranks. Humans decide.

EXPERIENCE

DFINITY Foundation - Zurich, Switzerland

STAFF RECRUITER | caffeine.ai (DFINITY Spin-off) | January 2025 - Present

- Partnered directly with founders to define the hiring roadmap, comp benchmarks, and interview processes for a zero-to-one AI startup
- Built the full recruiting stack from scratch — ATS, CRM, sourcing channels, employer brand, self-built MCPs — with no agency support
- Competed for scarce AI/ML and SRE talent against big-tech offers, closing senior specialists including the CTO
- Built LLM screening pipelines on Claude, self-built MCP servers (incl. GEM API), an AI-queryable knowledge base, and Scout, a prototype AI first-round interviewer

FREELANCE RECRUITER | June 2024 - December 2024

- Returned to DFINITY Foundation on a freelance basis to support recruitment needs
- Converted to internal Staff Recruiter after six months, at DFINITY's initiative

SENIOR RECRUITER | November 2021 – April 2023

- Contributed to 100 hires in 2022, specializing in Blockchain / Web3 R&D and supporting operational roles throughout Zurich and San Francisco
- Partnered with hiring managers, coached interviewers
- Sourced candidates, created outreach campaigns, and managed recruitment life-cycle, improved ATS and recruitment systems architecture
- Attended networking events and evaluated tools/services
- Developed and implemented diversity and inclusion hiring strategies
- Fostered strong relationships with universities and research institutions for talent pipeline

PROJECTS

Caffeine TA OS

(ATS/CRM, AI Note-Takers, MCPs, Claude, OpenAI, Knowledge Base, Scout)

Automated Screening Pipelines

(Claude, Custom Built)

Application Analytics using LLMs

Everything ATS

(Migration, Config, Admin, Digital Offers — Greenhouse, Lever, GEM, Jazz)

Exec & Team Reporting

(Looker, Custom Coded, Excel)

Candidate Test Library

(CoderByte, CoderPad, Codility, HackerRank)

Interview Script Library

(Confluence, Notion, G-Drive)

GDPR Implementation

Negotiation Training

(Pre-Closing, Closing)

Visa Applications Guide

(Switzerland, Germany)

EDUCATION/ CERTIFICATES

Bachelor in

Business Administration,

University of Cumbria
(Currently enrolled)

Diploma in

Business Administration,
Robert Kennedy College

People Analytics

University of Pennsylvania

GetYourGuide AG - Zurich, Switzerland

SENIOR TECHNICAL RECRUITER | July 2019 – August 2021

INTERIM TECHNICAL RECRUITMENT LEAD | April 2020 – September 2020

- Grew Zurich Engineering office and hired for all roles within Tech organization
- Owned recruitment process, managed funnel, leveraged channels, and networked
- Implemented a talent referral program to leverage employee networks
- Led team of 4, allocated resources, and aligned processes
- Provided regular hiring metrics and forecasts to stakeholders (CTO & CPO)
- Onboarded, coached, and mentored Recruiters, Sourcers, and Coordinators

Appway AG - Zurich, Switzerland

INTERIM PEOPLE OPERATIONS TEAM LEAD | Nov 2018 - Jun 2019

- Led team of 7, managed various HR functions, and reported to CFO
- Implemented time-reporting project and supported payroll adjustments
- Led on/off boardings, wrote reference letters and coordinated performance reviews with hiring managers

SENIOR RECRUITER | April 2016 – Sep 2018

- Led 2 recruiters, managed full-life cycle recruitment, and grew organization
- Provided candidate/stakeholder experience and reported to leadership
- Maintained tracking, revamped budget, attended events, and trained staff
- Redesigned careers page, migrated ATS systems, and digitized processes

Google - Zurich, Switzerland

TECHNICAL RECRUITER III | Jan 2014 – Jan 2016

- Hired for Software Engineering and Technical Program Management roles
- Led full hiring process, conducted reference checks, and negotiated offers
- Managed headcount and coordinated with various departments
- Collaborated with global recruiting teams to share best practices
- Used data-driven metrics to optimize recruiting and candidate quality
- Built strong stakeholder relationships to understand hiring needs

RM IT Professional Resources - Zurich, Switzerland

IT RECRUITER | Jan 2010 – Dec 2013

- Led full life-cycle of IT Contractor recruitment for various clients and sectors
- Built relationships, closed negotiations, and organized client interviews
- Advised candidates in relocation and managed online client distribution

Swiss Air Force - Duebendorf, Switzerland

STAFF SERGEANT | Jan 2008 – Dec 2009 (Finished in 2016)

COMINT (Communications Intelligence), EKF (Electronic Warfare Division)